Digital Survival Guide:
5 Rules Every Fresher Must Know

Project Report

Submitted as part of the requirements for

VITyarthi's Digital Literacy Project

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Introduction

In today’s world, digital literacy has become an essential skill for students, especially as most academic and professional activities are now carried out online. This project was designed to help understand and apply the basic concepts of digital literacy through practical tasks. As a student digital ambassador, the aim was to explore how different digital tools, platforms, and practices can be used effectively and responsibly.

Through this project, I worked on creating an awareness infographic, building a professional digital portfolio, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, understanding email etiquette, and studying cybercrime scenarios. Each task provided a different perspective on how students interact with the digital environment. Overall, this project helped in developing a better understanding of online safety, communication, and the importance of maintaining a professional digital presence from an early stage.

Task: 1

For Task 1, I created a one-page infographic titled **"Digital Survival Guide: 5 Rules Every Fresher Must Know"** using Canva. I chose Canva because it is simple to use and offers a lot of clean templates which made designing easier. The infographic focuses on four main areas that I feel are most important for a first-year student starting college life.

The first section highlights basic online safety, such as not sharing OTPs or passwords, avoiding suspicious links, and using strong passwords. The second part talks about useful digital tools like Google Docs for notes, GitHub for projects, and Canva itself for creating presentations. I also included a section on building a professional identity, where I mentioned creating a LinkedIn profile and starting projects early. Lastly, I added some basic email etiquette tips like writing proper subject lines, being polite, and avoiding slang.

While making this infographic, the most interesting part was organizing information in a very limited space without making it look crowded. At the same time, it was slightly difficult to keep the design simple while still making it visually appealing. Overall, this task helped me understand how important it is to present information in a clear and engaging way.

Task: 2

For Task 2, I created my digital portfolio by setting up profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. Each of these platforms serves a different purpose and together they help in building a strong online presence as a student.

On GitHub, I created a profile README where I introduced myself, mentioned my branch and year, and briefly described my interests in technology. GitHub is mainly used to showcase coding projects and track progress, so I plan to use it to upload my future projects and improve my coding consistency.

On LinkedIn, I completed my education details including my degree, college, and expected graduation year. LinkedIn helps in professional networking and is useful for connecting with seniors, recruiters, and professionals. I will use it over the next few years to build connections and stay updated with opportunities.

I also created a Kaggle profile to explore data science and practice problem-solving. Although I am just starting out, I plan to gradually participate in competitions and learn from datasets available on the platform.

Overall, this task made me realize that building a digital presence early is important, especially for students, as it helps in learning, networking, and preparing for future career opportunities.

Task: 3

For Task 3, I explored both a coding platform and a collaboration tool to understand how students can practically use digital resources for learning. I chose HackerRank for the coding part, where I solved a beginner-level Python problem. This helped me revise basic programming concepts and also gave me a feel of how coding platforms work, especially in terms of problem-solving and instant feedback.

For the collaboration part, I created a Google Form titled “Digital Survival Quiz for Freshers.” The form included five questions based on online safety, professional platforms, and email etiquette. I tried to make the questions slightly thought-provoking rather than very basic, so that it actually tests awareness instead of just memorization. After creating the form, I also viewed the responses in the linked Google Sheet to understand how data is collected and organized.

This task was interesting because it combined both technical practice and real-world application. Platforms like HackerRank can help in improving coding skills, while tools like Google Forms are useful for surveys, quizzes, and data collection in academic settings. Overall, it gave me a better idea of how digital tools can be used effectively for both learning and interaction.

Task: 4

For Task 4, I worked on understanding professional communication and responsible online behavior. I wrote two formal emails, one to a professor requesting an assignment extension and another to an internship coordinator expressing interest in a summer internship. While writing these, I realized how important it is to maintain a polite tone, clear structure, and proper subject lines, as even small mistakes can create a negative impression.

In addition to this, I created a checklist of social media do’s and don’ts for college students. This helped me think about how online behavior can affect one’s digital reputation.

A situation where poor digital communication can cause problems is when a student sends an informal or unclear email to a professor, which might be ignored or misunderstood. This can be avoided by using proper language, being respectful, and clearly stating the purpose of the message.

Task: 5

For Task 5, I focused on understanding cybercrime by exploring UPI payment fraud, which is very common among college students and new users of digital payments. While working on the case study, I realized how these scams are designed in a very simple but convincing way. Fraudsters often take advantage of a lack of awareness rather than using any complex technical methods. For example, sending fake payment links or asking users to enter their UPI PIN under the pretext of receiving money can easily mislead someone who is not familiar with how UPI actually works.

One thing that surprised me was how quickly such frauds can happen and how difficult it becomes to recover the lost money afterward. Even a small mistake or moment of carelessness can lead to financial loss and unnecessary stress.

While creating the prevention checklist, I understood that basic precautions like not sharing OTPs, avoiding unknown links, and verifying payment requests can make a big difference. As a result of this task, I will be more cautious while handling online transactions and will always double-check before taking any action related to payments or personal information.

Conclusion

This project helped me gain a practical understanding of digital literacy and how it applies to everyday student life. From creating an infographic to building online profiles and exploring different platforms, each task contributed to improving my awareness and skills. I also learned the importance of clear communication, especially while writing professional emails, and how small details can make a significant difference.

The cybercrime task was particularly insightful, as it highlighted how common online frauds can affect students and how easily they can be avoided with basic precautions. Overall, this project was not just about completing tasks, but about understanding how to use digital tools responsibly and effectively. It has encouraged me to be more mindful of my online activities and to continue improving my digital skills in the future.

References

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- GitHub – https://github.com
- LinkedIn – https://www.linkedin.com
- HackerRank – https://www.hackerrank.com
- Google Forms – https://forms.google.com